STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-13000	
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **06/04/25**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT HAZARDOUS MATERIALS	CROSS REFERENCE A-7100 EVIDENCE AND PROPERTY G-10210 FIELD COMMAND POST G-10410 COMMAND CENTER P-4420 EXPLOSIVE DEVICES			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for responding to calls where hazardous materials may be present.

II. Policy:

Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Road Patrol deputies may be called upon to provide assistance at a hazardous materials incident or may be the first responders at a hazardous materials incident. Responding or requested fire department personnel shall have primary responsibility at any such incident and shall provide guidance regarding perimeter, evacuation, and other public safety considerations.

III. Definitions:

A. HAZARDOUS MATERIAL: Any element, compound, or combination thereof, which is flammable, corrosive, explosive, toxic, radioactive, an oxidizer, an etiological agent, or is highly reactive and which, because of handling, storing, processing, and packaging may have detrimental effects upon emergency personnel, the public, equipment, and/or the environment (including gasoline and diesel fuel).

IV. Procedures:

A. Hazardous Materials-Deputy Responsibilities: Deputies may respond to hazardous material incidents ranging from small vehicle fuel spills to large material spills or releases of hazardous materials that may affect large areas within the County.

1. Upon arrival at any incident that may contain hazardous materials, the deputy shall attempt to contain the incident and establish a perimeter to prevent bystanders from be coming affected.

2. In case of a large hazardous materials release, the first responding deputy should assess the situation from a safe distance.

a) The deputy should obtain the wind direction and speed from Communications and attempt to stay up wind from the scene.

b) The deputy should attempt to determine the location of any injured persons.

c) The deputy should attempt to work with fire command to determine the need to evacuate nearby buildings or residences.

d) The deputy should determine if entry into the scene is safe. Deputies may consult fire command if scene safety is unknown.

3. If possible, the deputy shall make an identification of the material involved if such an identification can be safely made (identification may be made from placards, bills of lading or through witnesses). The deputy shall advise Communications if the identity of the material is ascertained.

4. If the fire department has not arrived yet, the deputy may have Communications contact Chemtrec at 1-800-262-8200 for assistance in identifying a hazardous material and with assistance regarding emergency procedures for hazardous materials.

5. In all cases where hazardous materials have been spilled, released, or require disposal, the appropriate fire department shall be requested.

6. Upon arrival of the fire department, the deputies shall provide perimeter security.

7. Deputies shall not take custody of or dispose of any hazardous material (including gasoline or diesel fuel) with the following exception:

a) Deputies may, at their discretion, take into custody for evidence or destruction: ammunition (.50 caliber or less), fireworks, or related items (e.g. reloading supplies), only if such items appear to be stable and not immediately dangerous, if handled properly.

b) If deputies take such items into custody, they shall complete an Evidence/Property form and an incident report (see A-7100 Evidence and Property).

c) If a deputy is uncertain regarding the safety of the ammunition, fireworks, or related items, he or she shall follow the explosive device procedures (P-4420 Explosive Devices).

B. Hazardous Materials-Supervisor Responsibilities:

1. The on-duty shift supervisor shall respond to all substantial hazardous material incidents (the shift supervisor need not respond to minor fuel spills resulting from property damage accidents).

2. The on-duty shift supervisor shall notify the on-duty watch commander or the ADC regarding all substantial incidents.

3. The shift supervisor shall coordinate with fire command to determine the need for evacuation, and begin if necessary.

4. The shift supervisor may establish a field command post; if necessary (see G-10410 Field Command Post).

5. Extremely large incidents may require the establishment of the Command Center and the initiation of Sarpy County Emergency Plans (G-10200 Command Center).